Yueyuan Ma

yueyuanma@ucsb.edu www.yueyuanma.com

AFFILIATION

UC Santa Barbara
Assistant Professor of Economics *2022-*

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania
Ph.D. in Economics *2016-2022*
Committee: Jeremy Greenwood (chair), Harold Cole, Hanming Fang, Emin Dinlersoz

Tsinghua University
M.A. in Economics (Distinction) *2014-2016*

Peking University
B.A. in Economics (Distinction); B.S. in Statistics *2010-2014*

RESEARCH INTEREST

Primary field: Macroeconomics
Secondary field: Economic Growth, Innovation, Firm Dynamics, Trade, Labor Economics

WORKING PAPERS

Expectations versus Reality in Business Formation, *with* Emin Dinlersoz

Technology Driven Market Concentration through Idea Allocation, *with* Shaoshuang Yang

Market Contraction and Innovation Divergence: The Impact of the US–China Trade War on Chinese Innovation, *with* Xiao Ma, Hanyi Tao, Yiran Zhang

PUBLICATIONS

Specialization in a Knowledge Economy, Sole Author, *Journal of Political Economy Macroeconomics, Volume 4, Number 1, March 2026*

'You Will': A Macroeconomic Analysis of Digital Advertising, *with* Jeremy Greenwood, Mehmet Yorukoglu, *the Review of Economic Studies, Volume 92, Issue 3, May 2025*

Are Spousal Labor Supplies Substitutes? Evidence from the Workweek Reduction Policy in China, *with* Xinzheng Shi, *Journal of Development Economics, Volume 145, June 2020*

Skill Complementarities and Returns to Higher Education: Evidence from the College Enrollment Expansion in China, *with* Hongbin Li, Lingsheng Meng, Xue Qiao, Xinzheng Shi, *China Economic Review, Volume 46, December 2017*

Interdisciplinary Work:
Position: AI-Agent Pricing Should Become More Outcome-Dependent: An Economic Perspective, *with* Yuheng Bu, *Accepted by NeurIPS 2026*

VISITING POSITIONS

Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis
Visiting Scholar *July 2022*

Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta
AEA Summer Fellow *June-July 2021*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

UC Santa Barbara
Instructor, Topics in Firm Dynamics (second-year Ph.D.)
Instructor, Advanced Macroeconomic Theory (first-year Ph.D.)
Instructor, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory (undergraduate)

University of Pennsylvania
Head Recitation Instructor, Introduction to Microeconomics and Introduction to Macroeconomics
Recitation Instructor, Intermediate Microeconomics
Teaching Assistant, Numerical Methods for Macroeconomics

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES/SERVICES

LAEF Conference on Market Power
Organizer *2026*

LAEF-HKU Joint Conference on Growth and Inequality
Organizer *2025*

Approved Special Sworn Status to the US Census data
Principal Investigator *2020-2025*
Joint project with Emin Dinlersoz *2023-*

China Employer-Employee Survey (CEES)
Interviewer *2015*

PRESENTATIONS (* scheduled)

2026
ASSA, NBER *Chinese Economy*, CES China Annual Conference, UConn Macro Conference, Women in Macroeconomics Conference (*discussant*) Inaugural CMT Conference on Expectations and Behavior, SITE Conference on Causes and Consequences of Misallocation, Firm Dynamics and the Macroeconomy Conference at FRB Atlanta*, SEA*

2025
LMU Macro Workshop, Virtual Seminar on Innovation and Economic Growth, Duke Macro Jamboree, NBER *Productivity, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship*, BSE Summer Forum *Economic Growth and Fluctuations*, Peking University, UIBE

2024
ASSA (*presenter and discussant*), UBC Vancouver, UC Riverside, Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, China International Conference in Macroeconomics, Macro-Finance Tepper-LAEF conference, Trans-Pacific Labor Seminar, University of Pennsylvania

2023
AFA (*discussant*), University of Florida, West Coast Search-and-Matching Workshop, North American Summer Meeting, Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society, SED, UIBE, Arizona State University, Macroeconomics Across Time and Space (Philly Fed), Rice Conference on Firms, Productivity, and Growth, Hitotsubashi & Kyoto University, UNC at Chapel Hill, SEA, Tsinghua University, UC Davis, University of Wisconsin–Madison

UC Irvine, USC Marshall Macro Day, St. Louis Fed, Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society, The 5th International Conference of China Development Studies, China International Conference in Macroeconomics (*discussant*), UC Santa Barbara, NYU Stern, Western University, National University of Singapore, Hong Kong University, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Peking University, York University *2022*

Chicago Fed Rookie Conference, US Census Bureau, Atlanta Fed, SED, WEAI, Virtual Macro Family Seminar, Penn Macro Seminar *2021*

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

Best Junior Scholar Paper Award
China International Conference in Macroeconomics (CICM) *2025*

William Polk Carey Prize
Recognize the best doctoral dissertation in Economics, University of Pennsylvania *2022*

Xingmei Graduate Fellow
School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania *2021*

Patrick C.H. Fellowship
School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania *2019*

Zhang Fellowship
School of Arts and Sciences, University of Pennsylvania *2018*

Beijing Outstanding Graduate
Beijing Municipal Education Commission *2016*

REFEREE SERVICE

AEJ Applied Economics, AEJ Macroeconomics, American Economic Review: Insights, China Economic Review, Econometrica, Empirical Economics, European Economic Review, International Economic Review, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Journal of Labor Economics, Macroeconomic Dynamics, Management Science, Theoretical Economics, The B.E. Journal of Macroeconomics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economic Dynamics, Review of Economics and Statistics.

COMMITTEE OR REFERENCE

(* First placement in parenthesis)

Postdoc	Shaoshuang Yang (CUHK Shenzhen, AP)
PhD Committee	Yang Gao (University of Auckland, AP), Yuanzhe Liu (Uber), Ariel Gao (Lyft), Rihyeon Kang, James Stuart-Turner (USAA), Emma Joergensen, Ryo Aono
Undergraduate	
Honors thesis advisor	Yaoqi Yang (UVA, PhD)

SKILLS

Computation	Matlab, Stata, R, SAS
Language	Chinese (native), English (fluent)